



NEWS LETTER

January 2025

Kerala has around 6200 + startups working in various sectors spread across its 14 districts. Our startups work in wide range of sectors including Artificial Intelligence, Hardware, Healthcare, Fin tech, Bio Technology etc.

01

KERALA STARTUP MISSION AND THE DEPARTMENT OF TOURISM HAVE SIGNED A GAME-CHANGING MOU TO BLEND INNOVATION WITH KERALA'S RICH TOURISM LEGACY!

The event was held in the presence of Hon. P.A. Mohammed Riyas, Minister for Public Works and Tourism, Smt. Sikha Surendran IAS, Director, Department of Tourism, Government of Kerala, S K Sajeesh, Chairman of KTIL, Anoop Ambika, Ceo, Kerala Startup Mission, Dr. Manoj Kumar Kini, Managing Director of KTIL and Muziris heritage project and Dr. Dileep M R , Director, Kerala Institute of Tourism and Travel Studies.



This partnership focuses on modern caravan parks, workstation pods, AI-driven kiosks, and sustainable solutions like eco-friendly sanitation systems. It also includes the launch of Freedom Square and the Hospitality & Tourism Innovation Centre to empower startups and redefine travel experiences. Together, we're setting a global benchmark for innovative and sustainable tourism!

02

HONORED TO HOST THE CHIEF SECRETARY OF KERALA AT KTIZ, KOCHI!

During the visit, the Chief Secretary engaged with our startups, gaining insights into their innovative ventures and exchanging ideas to further Kerala's vibrant startup ecosystem.



Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) made a remarkable impact at Kerala Literature Festival (KLF) 2025, bringing together technology, creativity, and entrepreneurship at Kozhikode Beach from January 23-26. The event showcased how startups are revolutionizing the arts and design industry through innovation.

A key highlight was the panel discussion, "Innovating through Creativity," held on January 25, where B Karthik Parasuram, Project Director, KSUM joined industry experts to explore the evolving role of startups in the creative ecosystem. Discussions revolved around emerging technologies, sustainable design, and the intersection of digital fabrication with artistic expression.

At the Experience Center, Fablab Kerala presented an immersive 3D printing workshop, allowing visitors to engage with digital fabrication firsthand. The standout installation, "Hemingway's Legacy," brought to life themes from *The Old Man and the Sea*, symbolizing resilience, struggle, and humanity's deep connection with nature.

By integrating art and technology, KSUM and Fablab Kerala transformed KLF 2025 into a hub of interactive learning, innovation, and inspiration. The event reaffirmed Kerala's position as a leader in creative entrepreneurship and technological advancement in the literary and cultural space.



04

TANZANIA GOVERNMENT & ACADEMIA DELEGATION VISITS KTIZ

Kerala Startup Mission had the privilege of hosting the Tanzania Government and Academia Delegation at KTIZ. It was an enriching experience to exchange ideas, foster meaningful discussions, and explore opportunities for mutual growth and learning.



05

POLAR BEAR PITCHING INDIA EDITION

Glimpses from India's first-ever Polar Bear Pitching competition. Brave startup founders took on the ultimate challenge pitching their ideas while standing in ice cold water showcasing resilience, innovation, and determination.

Congratulations to Fuselage Innovations winner of India edition , who emerged victorious and will now represent India at the grand finale in Oulu, Finland, in February 2025! Also a huge shoutout to all the start-ups who had participated.



06

INSIGHTSXCHANGE

Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) hosted an InsightsXchange session on January 8th, 2025, focusing on the medical diagnostic sector in the healthcare industry. The event featured an insightful talk by Mr. Bibu Punnooran, KMA President and Founder/MD of Medivision, on emerging technologies and their transformative impact on healthcare. The session provided participants with a deeper understanding of industry trends, challenges, and opportunities for innovation. The event aimed to foster meaningful discussions and networking opportunities in Kerala's startup ecosystem.



07

DARE TO DREAM 5.0 ROADSHOW



The Dare to Dream 5.0 Roadshow, organized by DRDO in association with Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM), was successfully held on January 17, 2025, at KSUM, Kochi. The event served as a platform for startups, researchers, and MSMEs to explore ground-breaking opportunities in defense and technology.

With a focus on fostering indigenous innovation, the session introduced the Dare to Dream 5.0 National Innovation Contest, encouraging participants to develop disruptive solutions in critical defense technologies. Experts from DRDO and industry leaders shared valuable insights on R&D collaboration, funding opportunities, and commercialization pathways for deep-tech innovations.

The event witnessed an enthusiastic turnout, with aspiring innovators engaging in thought-provoking discussions on emerging trends in defense tech. Kerala's growing startup ecosystem, backed by robust institutional support, was highlighted as a key enabler in driving technological advancements in the sector.

As India continues to push the frontiers of self-reliance in defense, initiatives like Dare to Dream 5.0 play a crucial role in inspiring young minds to contribute to national security through innovation.

08

STARTUP 360

The event covers areas such as business planning, technical design, legal requirements, financial management, and human resources. Learn about business planning, customer retention strategies, technical design, legal complexities, effective financial management techniques, and building a cohesive team. Take advantage of this chance to network with industry experts, learn from experienced entrepreneurs, and shape the future of startups!



The poster for the Startup 360 Kochi Edition event features a light blue background with a large '360' logo in blue and green. To the right, it says 'STARTUP 360 KOCHI EDITION' and 'KSUM OFFICE, KALAMASSERY KOCHI'. The date '30 JANUARY 2025' is prominently displayed. Logos for 'leap' and 'KERALA STARTUP MISSION' are also present. Below the text, there are five photographs showing participants engaged in discussions and networking. A text box at the bottom right states: 'The insightful sessions offered participants clarity, equipping them with practical solutions and strategic guidance. The event facilitated meaningful networking, strengthening a collaborative environment for innovation and progress.'



09

MENTOR LAUNCHPAD SESSION

KSUM recently hosted an orientation session aimed at introducing newly onboarded mentors to its mission, processes, and expectations. The event was enriched with valuable insights from senior mentors and provided a unique perspective from Startups on the role of mentorship in their growth.

Among the distinguished participants was Brajesh Kaimal, Member of the Malabar Angel Network, Surya Thankam, Manager at the Kerala Startup Mission and Firoz Musthafa, Cofounder of Thrillark. Overall, the orientation session was a successful initiative in fostering a community of mentors who are committed to the growth and development of startups in Kerala.

MENTOR LAUNCHPAD JAN 2025

GLIMPSES FROM THE ORIENTATION PROGRAMME FOR KSUM
ONBOARDED MENTORS



10

FOUNDER DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME

Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM), in collaboration with Mind Carter, successfully hosted the Founder Development Program on January 17, 2025, at the KSUM premises in Kochi. This transformative session brought together senior leaders from the startup ecosystem, including Founders, CEOs, COOs, CMOs, and CTOs, offering them valuable insights into leadership and team dynamics.





Global Game Jam Kochi 2025 was a thrilling celebration of creativity and collaboration! From January 24th to 26th, game developers, artists, and enthusiasts gathered at ISC-KSUM, Kochi, to create incredible games. With non-stop energy, innovative ideas, and a supportive atmosphere, the event showcased the best of indie game development. A huge thanks to all participants, judges, organizers, and sponsors for making it unforgettable.

The Ulcerheal Patch: A Revolutionary Solution for Mouth Ulcer Relief

Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) is proud to spotlight the innovative achievements emerging from Kerala's vibrant entrepreneurial ecosystem. Among these is the Ulcerheal Patch (Heal Ease), a product developed by Josna Mary Thomas, an Integrated MCA student at Amal Jyothi College of Engineering. Designed to provide effective relief for mouth ulcers, this edible, transparent patch is a testament to how innovation can transform everyday challenges into meaningful solutions.

The Ulcerheal Patch features a unique four-layer design, including a medicinal layer, a stain layer, a tapioca-based film, and an outer covering. It is crafted using natural ingredients such as B-complex vitamins and aloe vera gel to accelerate healing while alleviating pain. To ensure safe and allergy-free use, Josna incorporated sustainable materials like tapioca starch and natural adhesives. The patch is also fast-dissolving, disappearing within 20-30 minutes without leaving any residue, offering a seamless and convenient user experience.

What sets the Ulcerheal Patch apart is its use of natural stains like beetroot powder, turmeric, spirulina, and annatto seed, which aid in adhesion and optional flavoring, making it a functional and user-friendly product. The tapioca film not only forms a protective barrier to retain moisture but also promotes faster healing. This innovative approach highlights the potential for integrating sustainable materials with cutting-edge healthcare solutions.



The Ulcerheal Patch is already making waves, with a patent published and currently under examination. This milestone underscores the product's potential for large-scale impact in oral healthcare. Josna, driven by her passion for solving real-world problems through technology, has led this project from concept to recognition. Her journey includes participation in prestigious programs like Idea Fest 2023, in50hrs by KSUM, and the IEDC Summit 2024, where she gained valuable entrepreneurial insights and honed her innovation skills.



Connecting Academia and Industry: The Impact of Kerala's Instrumentation & Knowledge Graph

The Instrumentation and Knowledge Graph (IKG), an initiative by the Research Innovation Network Kerala (RINK), is digitally mapping the scattered scientific instruments across the state, making it easier for researchers and startups to access these valuable resources. The platform currently lists over 900 scientific instruments from more than 23 research and development facilities across Kerala. Institutions like the Sophisticated Test and Instrumentation Centre (CUSAT, Ernakulam) and Indian Institutes of Science Education and Research (Trivandrum) are participating in this initiative, offering access to these tools at reduced rates, especially for startups under the Kerala Startup Mission's UID category. By opening up these facilities to a wider audience, IKG is creating important connections between academia and industry, fostering collaboration and knowledge exchange. This easy access to state-of-the-art instruments not only accelerates research but also drives innovation, helping translate academic discoveries into real-world solutions.

Explore the scientific facilities at :

<https://instruments.startupmission.in/>



MENTORSHIP STATS (Dec and Jan)

18

STARTUPS

15

MENTORS

18

INTERACTIONS

Technical Committee Evaluation

The Startup Procurement Technical Committee conducted four meetings between October and January to evaluate the following projects

SI No	Name of the Department	Requirement	Startup	Amount Approved (in Lakhs)
01	Motor Vehicles Department	Online Student Concession Management System	Bassam Infotech LLP	3.54
02	Motor Vehicles Department	Creating Videos , Animation Videos & Learning Management System	SRV IT Hub	7.5
03	Kerala State Electricity Board Limited	Development of a web portal for the implementation of the Consumer Grievance Redressal Forum (CGRF) Regulations 2023	Bz Analytics	1.5
04	Cyberdome	Development of Cyber Security Enhancement Web Application for General Public	Magno Innovation Lab	10.04
05	Kerala State Industries Development Corporation	Event Website and Registration Management	Mojgenie Private Limited	9.4
06	Kerala Development Innovation and Strategic Council	Landslide Early Warning System	Augsense Lab Pvt Ltd	70.8
07	KRIBS BIONEST	Development of a web application	Kawika	3.5
08	Kerala Tailoring Workers Welfare Fund Board	Development of a website	Bz Analytics	0.85
09	Kerafed	Development of ERP Software	Turqosoft	14.95

10	Kerala State Disaster Management Authority	Installation of OBELIA at KSDMA - Reception Desk & Indoor Unit	Zaara Biotech	10.06
11	Vilappil Grama Panchayath	Installation of Bottle booth	Floret Technologies	0.29
12	Infopark	Digital Branding and Marketing	SRV IT Hub	21
13	Infopark	Advanced Air Purification System	Zaara Biotech	4.86
14	Kerala Startup Mission	Valet Parking Management System	Kokonet	9
15	Kerala Irrigation Infrastructure Development Corporation Ltd (KIIDC)	Procurement of Biodegradable preforms,Caps and Labels for Hilly Aqua Packaged Drinking Water	Eight Specialist Services Private Limited	46.46
16	Kerala Police	Development of Web portal for Cyber Division in Kerala Police	Bayesian Ways	2.5
17	Technopark	Development of Web portal for Affiliate Program for Government IT Park	Met Synergy	6.9
18	State Health Agency	Addition of new module to OP Portal Sruthitharangam	Kawika	4.84
19	Infopark	Energy Management Software	Alphageek Enterprises	10.97
20	Attingal Municipality	Sanitary Napkin Destroyer	Floret Technologies	0.47
21	Thaneermukkam Grama Panchayat	Segregation Conveyor Belt	Floret Technologies	6
22	Mangalapuram Gramapanchayat	Sorting Table and Conveyor Belt	Floret Technologies	6.72
23	Mulanthuruthy Grama Panchayat	Sorting Table	Floret Technologies	0.98
24	Ramamangalam Grama Panchayat	Sorting Table	Floret Technologies	1.4

OCTOBER- JANUARY

No of EOIs	25
Project Under Evaluation	8
Projects Approved	24
Value of work orders(in Lakhs)	254.53
Active EOIs	1

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Have a thought, comment or suggestion to share with us?

We'd love to hear from you.
Write to us at



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